

Chapter-3

Factual Description

Factual description is a formal piece of writing often used in writing biographies, describing objects, places, ideas or events. As the name suggests, a factual description is a systematic description of facts about a person, object, place or event. The writer describes the facts in detail covering various aspects of the person or the thing being described so as to enable the reader to get a comprehensive idea about the subject being described. A factual description is generally written in the form of paragraph.

Important Aspects of Factual Description

- ⇒ Objective description of the facts
- ⇒ Realistic and vivid description
- ⇒ Comprehensive description (covering various aspects)
- ⇒ Systematic description: One aspect at a time (For example: If you are describing the physical features of the object, you must not switch to its internal value)
- ⇒ Formal, correct language, no use of slangs
- ⇒ Variety in the use of vocabulary
- ⇒ No repetition
- ⇒ The length of factual description may vary depending on the purpose. For examination purpose, the length of a factual description will be limited, 80-100 words.

Describing People

While describing people the following points are considered important.

- ⇒ Physical traits:
- ⇒ Personality trait
- ⇒ Occupation/Profession
- ⇒ Routines/habits
- ⇒ Hobbies
- ⇒ Philosophy of life
- ⇒ Other people's opinion about the person

Physical Traits: age, height, body, structure, face, complexion, eyes, eyebrows, nose, lips, hair colour and type, clothes, etc.

Behaviour/Personality Trait: active, ambitious, creative, curious, talkative, out spoken, soft spoken, polite, rude, loving, caring, affectionate, kind, compassionate, strict, humble, proud, introvert, extrovert, shy, narrow/open-minded, amiable, friendly, weird, understanding, humorous, jovial, fun-loving etc.

Hobbies: singing, dancing, reading, surfing on net, painting, gardening, playing cricket/football/hockey etc.

Describing People : Sample : My Favourite Teacher

Mr. Sharma is my favourite teacher in the school. He teaches us science. He is a tall, handsome and well-built man. He is 40 years old. He is always smartly and formally dressed. He is very well-behaved, soft-spoken and polite. He is kind and compassionate. Sometimes he also cracks witty jokes. He explains the concepts very well. He is fond of reading books and playing golf. Everyone in the school appreciates and likes him. I really admire him a lot. May he live long!

[illegible]

[illegible]

Describing Objects

While describing objects the following points are considered important.

- ⇒ The name of the object
- ⇒ Model/year of manufacture
- ⇒ Brand/Company
- ⇒ Guarantee/warranty
- ⇒ Shape/structure
- ⇒ Colour and material
- ⇒ Contents/parts
- ⇒ Sizes available/dimension
- ⇒ Utility/capacity/functions/operational details
- ⇒ Availability
- ⇒ Price
- ⇒ Your remarks about the object/product
- ⇒ Your experience with the object/product

Describing Objects: Sample: Kindle



I have recently purchased a Kindle. Kindle is a small hand-held electronic device for reading books, which has been developed by online retailer Amazon. It is the latest model, Paper White, which has a high contrast touch screen which allows me to read even in bright sunshine with no glare. The device is extremely light weight and portable. I buy books as Kindle versions of 'e-books' from the Amazon website. In addition, I can also download PDFs of any sort of document, which makes this an ideal way of reading for work and study. It has a six-inch screen to read from and a small key board. It has built-in wifi and 3G connection to download books on to it. I can adjust the text size in it. It has battery life of at least a month if wifi is turned off. It also has a page-turning function to get the feel of reading a real book. It can store up to 1400 books. The books can be categorised or stored as collections. I can also add my own annotations to the text. It has also got a built-in Oxford English Dictionary. It also has the feature of password protection. Kindle has made my reading experience much more joyful and beneficial. I love it.

1. You have purchased a new laptop. Describe it including all its features.

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.